How we pay providers

Fee-for-service plans reimburse you or your provider for covered services. They do not typically provide or arrange for healthcare. Fee-for-service plans let you choose your own physicians, facilities and other healthcare providers.

The FFS plan reimburses you for your healthcare expenses, usually on a percentage basis. These percentages, as well as deductibles, methods for applying deductibles to families and the percentage of coinsurance you must pay vary by plan.

We offer benefits through the UnitedHealthcare Choice Plus network of individual physicians, medical groups, and facilities. These Plan providers accept a negotiated payment from us, and you will only be responsible for your cost-sharing (copayments, coinsurance, deductibles, and non-covered services and supplies), which may vary by plan.

We utilize Optum's Ingenix Claim Editing System (iCES) for United Health Network providers and Optum's Claims Editing System (CES) for non-United Health Network providers to review claims for bundling, unbundling, upcoding and other billing and coding edits using criteria that includes, but is not limited to National Correct Coding Initiative (NCCI) guidelines, Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS) guidelines, and Commercial (UHC) guidelines.

We reserve the right to audit medical expenses to ensure that the provider’s billed charges match the services that you received.

General features of our High Deductible Health Plan (HDHP)

HDHPs have higher annual deductibles and annual out-of-pocket maximum limits than other types of FEHB plans. FEHB Program HDHPs also offer health savings accounts or health reimbursement arrangements. Please see below for more information about these savings features.

Preventive care services

Preventive care services are generally covered with no cost-sharing and are not subject to coinsurance, deductibles or annual limits when received from a network provider.

Annual deductible

The annual deductible must be met before Plan benefits are paid for care other than preventive care services.

Health Savings Account (HSA)

You are eligible for an HSA if you are enrolled in an HDHP, not covered by any other health plan that is not an HDHP (including a spouse’s health plan, excluding specific injury insurance and accident, disability, dental care, vision care, or long-term care coverage), not enrolled in Medicare, have not received VA (except for veterans with a service-connected disability) or Indian Health Service (IHS) benefits within the last three months, are not covered by your own or your spouse’s flexible spending account (FSA), and are not claimed as a dependent on someone else’s tax return.

- You may use the money in your HSA to pay all or a portion of the annual deductible, coinsurance, or other out-of-pocket costs that meet the IRS definition of a qualified medical expense.
- Distributions from your HSA are tax-free for qualified medical expenses for you, your spouse, and your dependents, even if they are not covered by an HDHP.
- You may withdraw money from your HSA for items other than qualified medical expenses, but it will be subject to income tax and, if you are under 65 years old, an additional 20% penalty tax on the amount withdrawn.
- For each month that you are enrolled in an HDHP and eligible for an HSA, the HDHP will pass through (contribute) a portion of the health plan premium to your HSA. In addition, you (the account holder) may contribute your own money to your HSA up to an allowable amount determined by IRS rules. Your HSA dollars earn tax-free interest.
- You may allow the contributions in your HSA to grow over time, like a savings account. The HSA is portable – you may take the HSA with you if you leave the Federal government or switch to another plan.